

Observe and Report

Enforcing Policies and Following Procedures:
A Practical Guide for Resident Advisors

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Session Outline

- Policies
 - What are policies? But also why are policies?
 - Housing Contract
 - Residence Life Handbook
- Procedures
 - What is the RA process of addressing an incident?
- Practical Discussion
 - Scenarios

What is a policy?

But also why is a policy?

- Community Harmony
- Feel Safe
- Opportunity for Academic Success
- Live in Society
 - Lord of the Flies



Housing Contract & Residence Life handbook

To be an on campus resident each
of your students has signed the
[Student Residence Agreement](#)

All of our Residence Life
Policies are written down in the
[Residence Life Handbook](#)

- **Advertising/Bulletin Boards**
- **Accommodations & Accessibility**
- **Alcohol**
- **Animals/Pets**
 - **Fish 10 gallons or less**
 - **Service animal/ESA**
- **Antennas/Satellite dishes**
- **Appliances**
- **Bathrooms**
- **Bicycles**
- **Card access**
- **Cleaning and maintaining a physically health living environment**
- **Common Area Damage**
- **Computer use and resources**
- **Confidentiality**
- **Decorating/Displaying of Items**
- **Door locks and lockouts**
- **Drugs and illegal substances**
- **Electric and/or Motorized vehicles**
- **Elevators**
- **Emergencies**
- **Entry and Search**
- **False information**
- **Flammable liquids**
- **Furniture**
- **Gambling**
- **Guests**
- **Hallway and common area activity**
- **Hate crimes and bias motivated incidents**
- **Health and safety inspections**
- **Illegal entry**
- **Insurance and Liability**
- **Items Left in Student Rooms**
- **Keys and ID cards**
- **Lifesaving devices**
- **Lounges and Study rooms**
- **Mental health**
- **Noise**
- **Obstacles**
- **Open flames**
- **Painting**
- **Personal identification**
- **Removal from the Residence Halls**
- **Repair and Maintenance**
- **Residence Hall access**
- **Restricted Access**
- **Security Cameras**
- **Single residence occupancy**
- **Solicitation (general)**
- **Solicitation (political)**
- **Smoke and Tobacco-free environment**
- **Sports and Pranks**
- **Unauthorized entry**
- **Vandalism**
- **Waste recovery**
- **Waterbeds**
- **Weapons**
- **Windows and screens**

What is your role?

- You are not the police
 - This is not a court of law
 - We enforce policies, not laws
- Your authority has boundaries



Procedures



How DO I answer the duty phone?

Insert Hall Name RA on
duty this is *insert your
name*



How to address and INcident

- First things first take a deep breath
- Maintain a level head
- Ask for help
 - Your fellow RA on duty, Public Safety, CD/GSA on duty



How to address and Incident make contact



Identify yourself as an RA

You should be wearing your name tag and Residence Life/St. Thomas apparel

Rooms within Rooms?

Knock loudly and clearly. If other residents open their door thinking you're knocking on theirs, you're on the right track

Be straightforward, maintain calm

When they answer the door

- Identify what drew your attention - be specific
- Explain why the behavior is a problem - refer to policy

How to assess the situation

- What is it that drew your attention?
- Now that you can see more what is happening?
 - Is anyone hurt?
 - Is there risk to someone's health/well-being?
 - What, if any, policy violations are taking place?



How to address and Incident -Attention

What do you hear? What do you smell? What do you see?



Communicate with residents

- Explain why it is that you knocked/made contact
 - Give directions as needed: “I need you to open the door.” “I need you to turn off the music.”
- If appropriate, get more information about what happened
- If possible, collect student IDs of everyone involved
 - Collect ID numbers if they say they don’t have them
 - Student IDs of non-St. Thomas Students/Other forms of IDs for non-students
- Don’t let people leave – “Stay where you are please, I’ll ask you to have a seat.”
 - But if they do leave, let them go

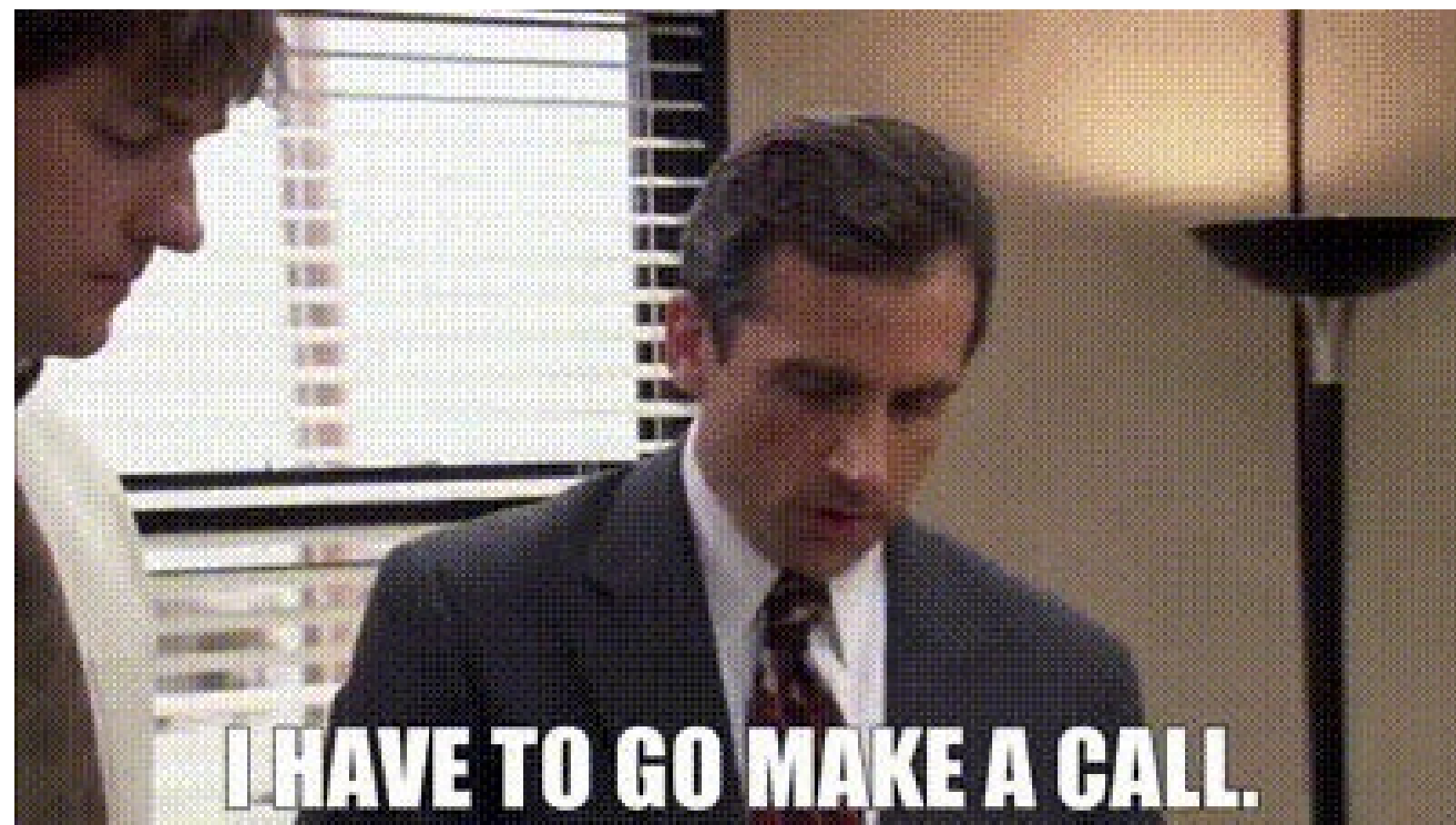




Communicate with Residents

- Allow Public Safety to do their thing
- Do not minimize the situation
- It's okay if you aren't able to answer all questions

Who are you going to call?



Documenting it

Input everything
into an Incident
report in advocate

- General Concern/FYI
- Code of Conduct



Worth writing it
out via a word doc
first

- Narrative format
- Third person
- Avoid pronouns
- Be detailed

***Even if public Safety says you don't need**

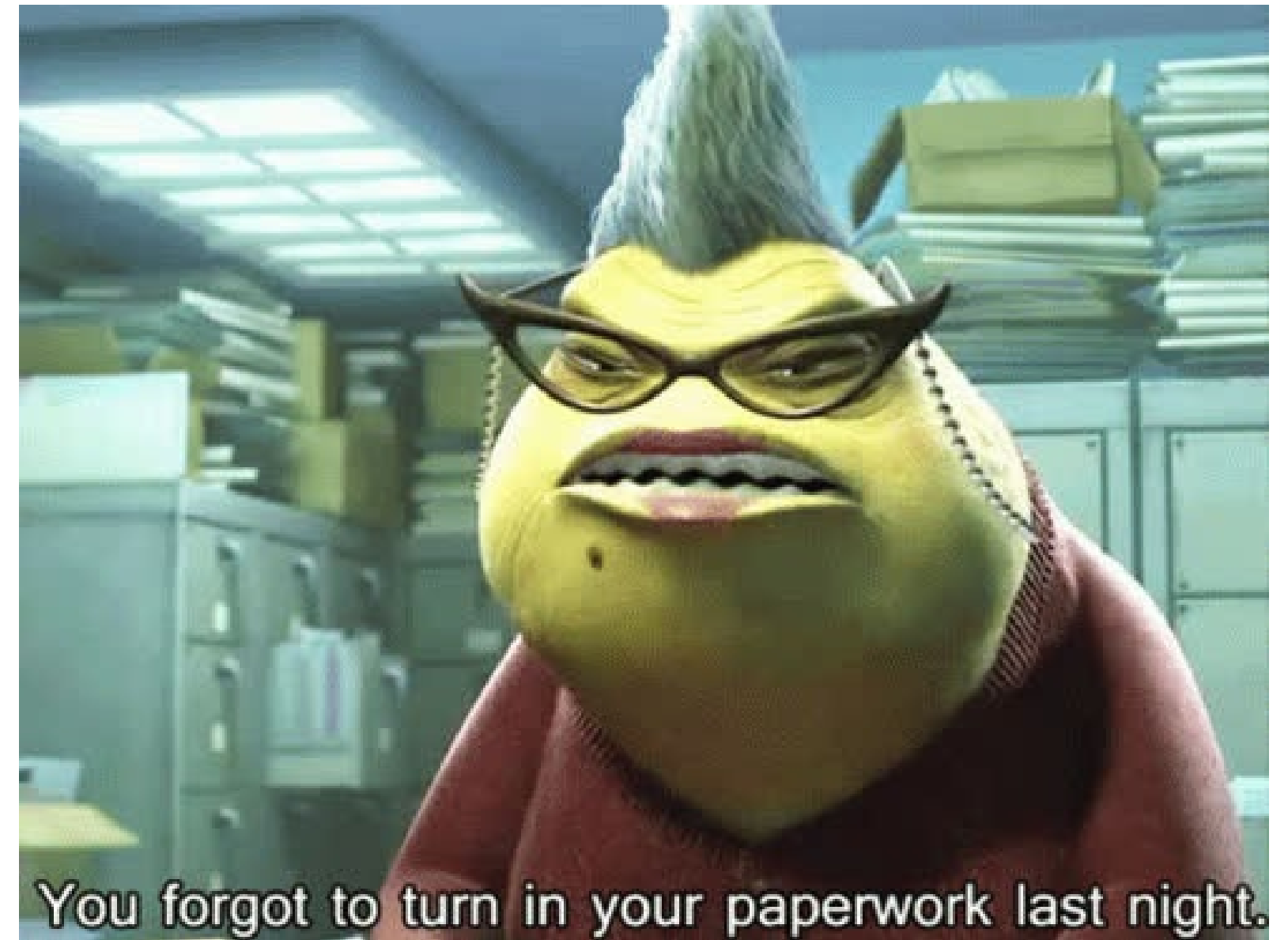
Wrapping up contact



- Get ICR# from Public Safety to include Advocate Report
- Get names of Public Safety Officers present
- If policy violation is involved, you can remind them they may be contacted by:
 - Residence Life or
 - Dean of Students Office
- Connect with the residents again in a non-conduct related situation. Don't judge your residents based on one instance of bad decision making

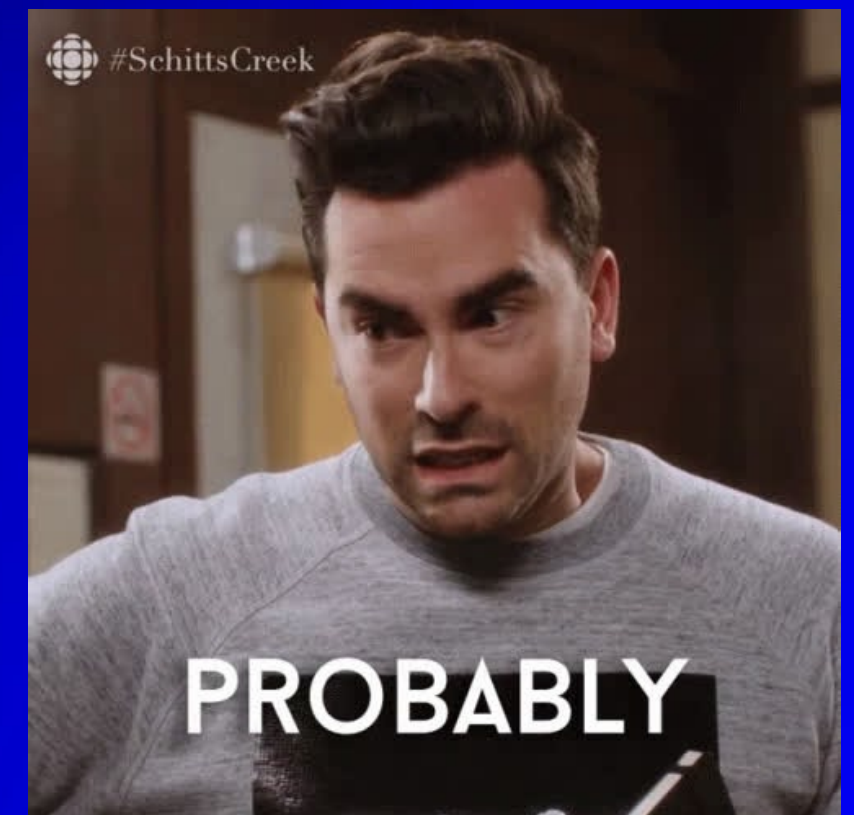
Documenting It

- Throughout the incident collect relevant information:
 - Time/date
 - Location/s
 - Name/IDs of involved students/guests
 - Write down direct quotes if possible/relevant
 - Describe the situation (behaviors, substances involved, interactions, etc.)



Common incidents to address

We're now going to talk through some scenarios you are likely to encounter



Common Incidents to address

- Walk through the steps of the whole interaction beginning to end
- What, if any, policies issues need to be addressed?
- What factors may be contributing to risk/harm to students?
- Who would you call?

Large group share out:

- What are some unique factors for your scenario type?

Common Incidents to address

You're in your room between rounds and you hear someone sobbing in the hallway. It has been a quiet night and many of your residents went home this weekend. You exit your room and walk towards the sound. You see someone in the hallway sobbing uncontrollably, they are familiar to you but they're not one of your residents

- Walk through the steps of the whole interaction beginning to end
- What, if any, policies issues need to be addressed?
- What factors may be contributing to risk/harm to students?
- Do you need to call anyone?

Common Incidents to address

Your event is happening in the floor lounge and as the event is wrapping up you see one of your residents coming down the hallway. They look like they might have fallen as they have a large rip in their pant leg and what looks like mud all down their back. They seem to be having some difficulty, and you also see that they're holding a bottle in their hand. Before you have a chance to speak to them, they enter room 113.

- Walk through the steps of the whole interaction beginning to end
- What, if any, policies issues need to be addressed?
- What factors may be contributing to risk/harm to students?
- Do you need to call anyone?

Common Incidents to address

While you're on your first set of rounds a resident report to you that there is a strange smell coming from the end of their hallway. The resident doesn't know exactly which room, but they report to you it happens regularly.

- Walk through the steps of the whole interaction beginning to end
- What, if any, policies issues need to be addressed?
- What factors may be contributing to risk/harm to students?
- Do you need to call anyone?

Common Incidents to address

While on rounds, you notice that the door to the bathroom is open and that water is flowing into the hallway. You walk in and see about an inch of water covering the entire floor but there is no running water in that bathroom but there is a ceiling tile on the floor.

- Walk through the steps of the whole interaction beginning to end
- What, if any, policies issues need to be addressed?
- What factors may be contributing to risk/harm to students?
- Do you need to call anyone?

Common Incidents to address

You're sitting at the desk during your shift and there is someone standing in the entryway they've been there for about 10 minutes and have knocked on the glass to get your attention.

- Walk through the steps of the whole interaction beginning to end
- What, if any, policies issues need to be addressed?
- What factors may be contributing to risk/harm to students?
- Do you need to call anyone?

QUESTIONS?
COMMENTS?
CONCERNS?
COMPLAINTS?

